The two biggest changes in AI video this month

In the last two weeks two releases changed how we make AI films. We tested both in our own studio before telling you. Your studio kit now uses them by default: update it once (page 2) and your Claude does the rest.

Change 1, pictures

GPT Image 2.6 is the new default for images

OpenAI's new image model (the "Sunburst" version) is a clear step up from 2.5. Skin, hair and light now read as photographed at full size, and the waxy, plastic look is gone.

- Use it for places, products, thumbnails, posters and final stills.
- About **$0.19 an image** at 2K on EvoLink.
- Prompt it like a photographer: "a real photograph", the time of day and where the light comes from, "subtle film grain, natural colour", no retouching.

Change 2, video

Gemini Omni is the new default for video

Google's new video model, Gemini Omni 1.2 Flash, is cheaper, quick to generate, and in our tests gave the most natural faces we have made, straight from words. Seedance 2.5 stays as the backup.

- About **a fifth of Seedance's price** per second.
- **Extend:** continue a clip with the same person, clothes and light. No reference photo needed.
- **Edit:** fix one thing in a take instead of starting again.

The new way to make a scene with people

1 **Cast in motion.** Make a 5-second "screen test" of your person on Gemini Omni: a close-up, a slow head turn. Don't start from a generated photo: people cast in video look filmed, people from a still look like stock photography.

2 **Grow the scene with extend.** Continue the screen test or any shot by 3 to 10 seconds at a time. Tell Claude where the clip ends ("she has just turned to her right") so the next part keeps the same direction.

3 **New place, new shot.** Extend only adds to the end. For a new location, Claude uses frames from the screen test as references so it is still the same person.

4 **Fix, don't re-roll.** One short instruction ("remove the cup from the table, keep everything else the same") repairs a take.

Omni costs about a fifth of Seedance

Job (EvoLink, November 2026)	Gemini Omni 1.2 Flash	Seedance 2.5, backup
5-second shot, 720p	about $0.34	about $1.47
Per second, 720p	about $0.07	about $0.29
Add 5 seconds to a clip (extend)	about $0.34	not available
One still image, 2K (GPT Image 2.6)	about $0.19	about $0.19

Good to know: Omni makes sound with every clip, so say what you want to hear (and "no music" if you don't want it). It delivers 720p today; Claude can upscale a final. Clips run up to 15 seconds per generation; extend takes them longer. When Omni is busy, or a shot needs Seedance's strengths (up to 30 seconds, native 1080p, lip sync to a voice file), Claude switches to Seedance and tells you.

Update your studio kit

Your studio kit lives on GitHub. Updating it gives your Claude both new defaults, the new Gemini Omni directing skill and the prices on page 1. Your keys, notes and productions are never touched.

The studio kit, save this link

github.com/Trueflutter/film-studio

Full address: https://github.com/Trueflutter/film-studio
Update guide: https://github.com/Trueflutter/film-studio/blob/main/UPDATE.md

How to update

1. Open Claude Code in your studio folder (usually **Documents/my-studio**).
2. Give Claude this PDF and say **"Do what this says."** Or copy the instructions below and paste them in.
3. When Claude asks, quit Claude Code and open it again in your studio folder.
4. Check you have EvoLink credit: Gemini Omni 1.2 runs on EvoLink today. Aristotto offers Omni 1.1 now and 1.2 when it arrives; Claude picks the newest.

Instructions for Claude

Paste this into Claude Code, or give Claude this PDF.

The student wants their AI video studio updated to the latest Saqr Academy studio kit, version 1.6.8 or newer.

1. **Follow the update guide exactly:** https://github.com/Trueflutter/film-studio/blob/main/UPDATE.md. The kit's only home is https://github.com/Trueflutter/film-studio (marketplace "saqr-film", plugin "film-studio"). If it was installed from anywhere else, replace it as the guide says.
2. **Never** read, print, change or ask for their API keys. Never overwrite .env, .mcp.json, anything under "## My studio notes" in CLAUDE.md, or anything in productions/.
3. **Check the result:** "claude plugin list" shows film-studio 1.6.8 or newer; the plugin has the skill "omni-directing"; the studio rules in CLAUDE.md say "studio-rules v6"; "film doctor" passes.
4. **From now on, in this studio:**
   - Video: Gemini Omni 1.2 Flash by default, through the omni-directing skill (a screen test to cast people, extend to continue a clip and keep the screen direction, edit to fix a take). Seedance 2.5 is the fallback, through seedance-directing.
   - Still images: GPT Image 2.6 Sunburst (EvoLink gpt-image-2.6-sunburst, 2K, quality xhigh), through the image-prompt skill.
   - Show the cost before anything is generated.
5. **Tell the student** in a few short lines: the version they are on now, the two new defaults, and that their keys, notes and productions are exactly as they were. Ask them to restart Claude Code if needed.

Try it after the update

Ask your Claude: "Cast a woman in her thirties for a property ad: do a Gemini Omni screen test, then extend it so she walks into the living room." It costs well under a dollar and shows you both changes at once.